

Negotiation Rubric

Day 5 handout. The dimensions each quad scores both sides on, every round. Reference this while observing; record scores on the printed score sheet.

Scoring dimensions

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary
Listened first	20%	Restated the stakeholder's concern before responding
Translated tech to business	20%	No unexplained jargon; framed cost in business terms
Held the line where it mattered	15%	Did not surrender constraints under social pressure without rationale
Found the trade space	20%	Surfaced what could move (scope, time, quality, resources)
Captured the outcome	15%	Specific, written, with owner + next step
Body / pacing / closure	10%	Conversation reached a decision (or explicit deferral)

Score each dimension on a **1–4 scale** (1 = absent, 2 = attempted, 3 = solid, 4 = exemplary). The round total is out of 4.0.

Round structure (~30 min each)

- **5 min** prep — re-read packet
- **15 min** live negotiation
- **10 min** debrief + capture

Debrief prompts (use each round)

- What was the highest-leverage moment?

- What did the author *quad not* hear from the stakeholder?
- What language did the author use that should be retired?
- Which trade-space axis did the stakeholder push? Which did the author offer?
- What's the owner + next step? (Force this — don't let a round end without it.)

The trade space (the concept the rounds test)

Negotiation surfaces when **at least one axis can move**:

- **Scope** (what's in)
- **Time** (when it ships)
- **Quality** (level of polish)
- **Resources** (who's working on it)

If nothing can move, you're not negotiating — you're saying yes or no. A skilled TPM finds which axis the stakeholder cares most about, and offers movement on a *different* one.